

The Auspiciousness of the Three Families (Tibetan: Rigs gsum gyi bkra shis; Sans

Toh 825 · Derge Kangyur

The Auspiciousness of the Three Families (Tibetan: Rigs gsum gyi bkra shis; Sanskrit likely *Trikulamaṅgala* or similar) is a short liturgical verse text preserved as Toh 825 in the Kangyur, belonging to the genre of auspiciousness prayers (bkra shis, maṅgala-gāthā) recited for blessing and well-being. After paying homage to the Three Jewels, it invokes in turn the three bodhisattva protectors—Mañjuśrī, Avalokiteśvara, and Vajrapāṇi—describing their symbolic colors, implements, and qualities as embodiments of wisdom, compassion, and the union of method and wisdom respectively. Each verse culminates in a request that the auspiciousness of that noble being bring goodness and well-being to the present day, giving the text a structured, incantatory form typical of ritual dedication prayers. As part of the Kangyur, it represents the class of canonical materials used in everyday liturgical and devotional practice rather than doctrinal exposition.

The Auspiciousness of the Three Families.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

As a sign of vast qualities, his body's hue is like gold;
as a sign of wisdom, he holds in hand a sword and a volume of scripture.
Whatever is the auspiciousness of the noble Mañjuśrī, the youthful,
by that sacred auspiciousness, may there be goodness and well-being here
today.

As a sign of compassion, his body's hue is imbued with moonlight;
unstained by any fault, he holds in hand the emblem of a lotus.
Whatever is the auspiciousness of the noble Avalokiteśvara,
by that sacred auspiciousness, may there be goodness and well-being here
today.

As a sign of the unchanging nature of reality, his body's hue is deep
blue-black;
as the nonduality of method and wisdom, he holds a vajra in hand.
Whatever is the auspiciousness of the noble Vajrapāṇi,
by that sacred auspiciousness—

Translator's Notes

- The source text opens with "rdzogs so" ("[it is] complete"), a colophon marker evidently belonging to a preceding work, not to this text itself; it has been omitted from the translation as extraneous to the present passage. The passage itself breaks off mid-sentence at the end (after "bkra shis..."), so the final line dedicated to Vajrapāṇi's auspiciousness is left incomplete, matching the manuscript.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.